

Elaine C. Yao

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Academic appointments

2025– Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science, Washington University in St. Louis

Education

2019–25 PhD Politics; MA Politics, Princeton University
2013–17 AB Economics (*General and departmental honors*), University of Chicago

Research

PUBLICATIONS

[Brook no compromise: How to negotiate a united front](#) *American Journal of Political Science* 70.2 (2026): 643-657

[How Soft Propaganda Persuades](#) (with Daniel Mattingly) *Comparative Political Studies* 55.9 (2022): 1569-1594

[Authoritarian Responsiveness and Political Attitudes during COVID-19: Evidence from Weibo and a Survey Experiment](#) (with Lai Wei and Han Zhang) *Chinese Sociological Review* (2021): 1-37

WORKING PAPERS

[Tactical choice in repeated protests](#)

Conferences, workshops, talks

INVITED TALKS & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2025–26 PolEconUK Webinar, Columbia (Political Economy), National Taiwan University (SPE, Political Economy); APSA[†], MPSA[†] *Scheduled: SITE 2026* (Political Economy session)
2024–25 WashU, NYU (Political Economy); APSA
2023–24 WashU Conference for Early Career Scholars in Theoretical Political Economy; MPSA
2022–23 Kellogg Center Workshop on Formal Models of Politics (Virginia Tech); Comparative Politics and Formal Theory (Rochester)^{poster session}; MPSA, SPSA
2020–21 Chinese Political Economy Workshop (NYU), NYU Quantitative China Studies Seminar

CONFERENCES ATTENDED

WashU Current Research in Political Economy (2026)[†], Princeton-Warwick-Yale Political Economy Conference (2025, 2026), WashU Conference on Global Threats to Peace and Democracy (2025)[†], WashU Conference for Early Career Scholars in Theoretical Political Economy (2025), Yale Political Economy of Political Institutions (2025)

[†] = *discussant (in addition to presentation and/or attendance)*

Teaching and advising

Classes taught at WashU:

Fall 2025, 26 Politics and the Theory of Games (undergraduate lecture)
Spring 2026 Frontiers in Formal Theory and Comparative Politics (PhD seminar)

Advising: Shuren Zheng (committee member), Niko Dawson (3rd year paper reader)

Professional activities

REFEREEING

American Journal of Political Science, American Political Science Review, Journal of Politics, Comparative Political Studies, British Journal of Political Science, World Politics, International Studies Quarterly, Political Science Research and Methods, sPolitical Behavior, Journal of Experimental Political Science, Chinese Journal of Communication, Social Media + Society

SERVICE

Formal Theory section chair, 2027 MPSA annual meeting
Committee member, Formal Theory Section Award for Best 2025 APSA Paper

Other Employment

2017–19 Senior Research Analyst, Financial Intermediation, Federal Reserve Bank of New York

References

Matias Iaryczower

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Princeton University
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Carles Boix

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